Hope Hospitals		**TELEMEDICINE GUIDELINES**
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1. Objective

To ensure safe, secure, and ethical delivery of healthcare through telemedicine to improve accessibility for patients, especially in remote or follow-up settings.

2. Scope

Applies to:
- All doctors and consultants offering remote consultations
- Nurses assisting in tele-triage
- IT and admin staff involved in scheduling or maintaining records
- Patients using Hope Teleconsult platform

3. Types of Telemedicine Services Offered

Mode	Used for
Video Consultation	Specialist consultation, follow-up
Audio Consultation	Follow-up, clarification, counselling
Text/Chat	Prescription review, appointment queries
Store-and-Forward	Sharing lab reports, radiology, photos

4. Eligibility & Use Case

✅ **Allowed:**

- Follow-up consultations
- Non-emergency cases
- Second opinion
- Mental health counselling
- Prescription for chronic diseases (e.g., diabetes, BP)

❌ **Not Allowed:**

- Emergency assessment (e.g., chest pain, stroke)
- First-time psychiatric medication without in-person visit
- Procedures requiring physical examination

5. Consent

- Implied Consent: When patient initiates the call.
- Explicit Consent: If provider initiates, patient must agree via text or email.
- Consent is documented and retained.

6. Documentation

Each teleconsultation must have:
- Patient ID/UHID
- Date and time of consultation
- Mode (audio/video/chat)
- Summary of complaints, diagnosis, advice
- Prescription (if given)
- Consultant's name and signature (digital or typed)

Records maintained for minimum 3 years.

7. Prescriptions

- As per Telemedicine Guidelines:
  - List O (Safe OTC): Can prescribe in first consult.
  - List A: Can prescribe in follow-up video/audio consult.
  - List B and Schedule X/Narcotics: Not allowed via telemedicine.
- E-prescription includes doctor's registration number (MCI/MMC), date, hospital name.

8. Technology & Security

- Platform used: Ayushman Teleconsult (via Zoom/WhatsApp Business/Google Meet)
- All devices must have:
  - Password protection
  - Antivirus software
  - End-to-end encryption (for video)
- Patients instructed not to record without permission

9. Training

- All doctors and nurses oriented via SOP briefing
- Staff trained on:
  - Data privacy
  - Technical handling
  - Consent protocols
  - How to handle disconnection/emergency redirection

10. Emergency Redirection Protocol

If a patient appears to need urgent/emergency care:
- Stop the teleconsult
- Instruct to visit nearest hospital
- Call 108 if needed
- Document action taken and time